

CENSOR TO CONTROL

The pointlessness of it all!

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Everywhere you look, we're being muzzled. Led about like horses with blinders "for our own good".

To control and stop terrorism they monitor our digital lives... Yes please, just stop them!

Now it's piracy, or porn, or whatever suits a politician's fancy to try and stop or censor. Perfectly useful sites such as Github and Archive.org have been blocked in the past, and whatever the reasons or however well intentioned the motive, we're bordering on total control of the internet! It's not just the press anymore, it's you. Everyone is fair game now!

This cover story will help you prevent this from becoming the norm... or what's the worst that will happen? Read on...

If you've been following current events, you know that the world is pretty insane at the moment. What we've wanted to do for a while now is to tackle censorship, which we feel is a rubbish idea. Don't believe us? Ask the British. Yes you read that right, the United Kingdom has more censorship than us. Actually they're kind of more comparable in censorship to Saudi Arabia, Iran, Russia, Pakistan and China than they are to us... we're still liberal in comparison!

The problem is that once you get people used to the idea that the government knows best, well, you're screwed. We all know the theory, the government consists of people elected by us, and thus are the best representative of our collective will... yada, yada, ad nauseum, ad infinitum.

If we were electing computer programs to run our affairs, then yes, this would work flawlessly. We know code, and what it's designed to do; we don't know people, and what hidden agendas they may have, or even what their biases or leanings are. Plus, people lie, computers don't.

Now all of us are aware of the lack of freedom in the physical world, especially in India, where any group bigger than 10 with a fistful of cash can pretty much take over a street and inconvenience hundreds if not thousands of people, because, heck,

it's mob rule, and politicians are quick to appease any seemingly popular or "large" group. However, dare you express your opinion on social media that "hurts someone's sentiments", (an important someone obviously, not unimportant people like us); depending on what you said it's either jail, death, being beaten up or made to eat crow in some horrendous manner - all because someone was butthurt by your words or drawings!

What's worse is that apologists will nod their heads knowingly, and say, "(S)he had it coming... you can't just say anything you want!". These apologists probably define free speech as:

Free Speech (noun) the right to express opinions with as much censorship and restraint as possible, without being charged a fee for doing so.

A millipede in a mine field

(For their army of legs, you know?)

The aim is to get people to self censor. Why? Because you can't really beat up or jail a million voices, but by publicly doing it to a few, even if you apologise later, it's bound to silence a million who will think, "Better be careful, I don't want that to be me!" So we end up tiptoeing all our lives.

Terrorism

"You can't complain! Gasp! If you do, the terrorists win! How can you fault censorship if it helps stop terrorism?"

Yes, that's the kind of "logic" people have used in the past.

Ever thought that the terrorists are also for censorship, and kill to silence dissenters or people of other opinions? So what's the difference between what governments try and do to you?

Big corporations do the same to smaller ones by threatening to sue. Censorship in the name of terrorism is pretty much just one bully harassing you by claiming to protect you from another! And for the love of god, just leave Github and Archive.org alone, would you?

Piracy

Die ye surfing scallywags! Think of the poor movie stars and recording artists who have to go through life being rich, but not filthily so. If only you'd stop pirating, they'd be able to buy a third private jet so their groupies don't have to travel, ugh, first class!

Imagine a world without piracy. Seriously, close your eyes, imagine this alternate reality. What did you get? An image of a world where Linux was the dominant OS (95%), we're all watching YouTube videos for entertainment, and listening to internet radio with ads... Or did you actually imagine being a lot poorer than you already are because you paid for all the pirated stuff you have consumed in this reality? Get it?

Still, it makes a great story when you orchestrate a manhunt across continents to catch a few The Pirate Bay geeks! This is the entertainment industry's version of "We got him!" So what does all this do to piracy? Honestly, absolutely nothing.

Porn!

Perverts. Degenerates. Don't you know that all of you porn watching people can at any moment turn into rapists or serial killers?

It's not like you need science and studies to prove any of this. A politician's opinion is usually good enough in our country. The land that gave the world the Kamasutra will now ring the alarm bells on online skin.

As an aside: the Digit team had a gala time surfing for porn in the office. Why? We wanted to research exactly how messed up Indians are when it comes to this. Turns out, people are just depraved perverts! We've even read comments on a picture that made our brains want to explode. What was the picture of? A shot of naked feet! Go ahead powers that be, block porn in 2015, and see the country really go crazy!

So what does this all amount to? Nada. Zip. Zero. Nothing. A great goose egg! That's the entire point of the stories that follow - the absolute pointlessness of censorship, and why you shouldn't allow it! **d**